Alexander Diamla Dumpa

Alexander Diamla Dumpa (born June 3, 1996) is a Filipino jurist, educator, and public official from Tamparan, Lanao del Sur.

A proud Maranao, he is best known for his extraordinary academic record at Mindanao State University, where he made history as the first student ever to graduate with Magna Cum Laude distinction from the MSU College of Law.

From selling watermelons at a public market in Tamparan to becoming a national policymaker at 25, Dumpa's life story has become one of the most compelling narratives in Bangsamoro legal history, a testament to what discipline and education can do for a young person from a marginalized community.

He served as a Commissioner of the Legal Education Board (LEB) from 2021 to 2026, where he championed law student welfare and helped embed Shari'ah legal studies into the national legal education framework.

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Early Life and Background

Dumpa grew up in Tamparan, a municipality in Lanao del Sur in the heart of the Bangsamoro region.

His early years were not easy.

To support his schooling, he worked as a watermelon vendor at the local public market in Tamparan, a detail that has since become central to how he's described and celebrated in Philippine legal circles.

That experience, he has noted, shaped the values that carried him through his academic and professional life: perseverance, humility, and an abiding belief in the power of education to change lives.

Education and Academic Achievement

Dumpa's academic career is defined by a string of firsts that no student at Mindanao State University had achieved before him.

Bachelor of Science in International Relations (2017)

He completed his undergraduate degree at MSU Main Campus, graduating as University Class Valedictorian and Magna Cum Laude.

He finished the program one semester ahead of schedule and walked away with 13 distinct awards at graduation.

Among them was a national honor: he was named one of the Ten Outstanding Jose Rizal Model Students of the Philippines in 2016.

Juris Doctor (2022)

Dumpa went on to earn his law degree at the MSU College of Law, again graduating as University Class Valedictorian and Magna Cum Laude, with a General Point Average of 1.39.

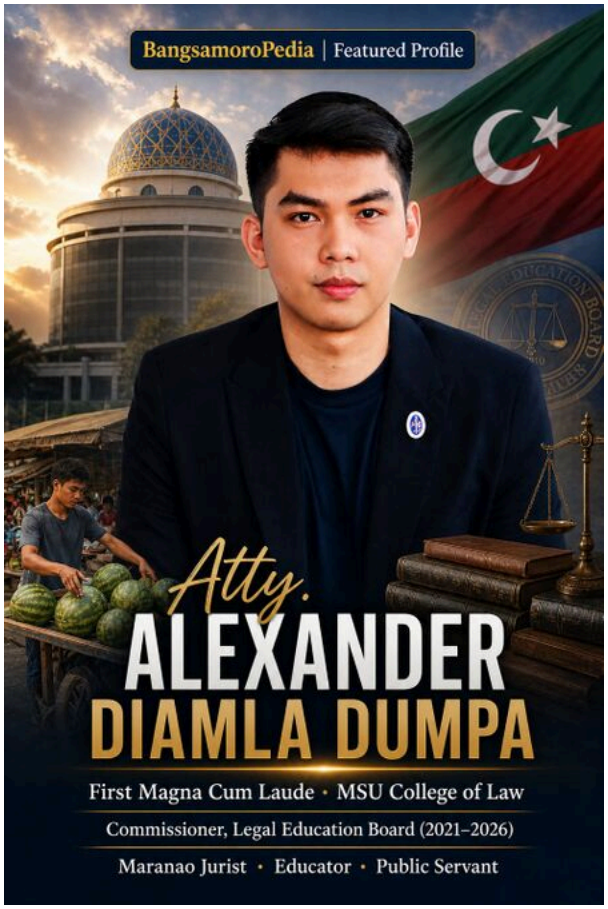
He became the first student in the entire history of the MSU College of Law to earn the Magna Cum Laude distinction, a milestone that marked a new standard for academic excellence in that institution.

Master of Laws (2025)

He completed his graduate legal studies at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) under the Public Governance Track, finishing with a General Weighted Average of 1.10.

His thesis, *Governing the Mind: A Doctrinal Analysis of Philippine Supreme Court Jurisprudence on Academic Freedom,* was awarded the Best Thesis Award.

Atty. Alexander Diamla Dumpa



Born	June 3, 1996
Birthplace	Tamparan, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Ethnicity	Maranao
Nationality	Filipino
Occupation(s)	Jurist, Educator, Public Official
Known for	First Magna Cum Laude graduate, MSU College of Law; Commissioner, Legal Education Board; Advocate for law student welfare
Education	B.S. International Relations (MSU, 2017); Juris Doctor (MSU, 2022); Master of Laws (PUP, 2025)
Alma mater	Mindanao State University; Polytechnic University of the Philippines

Professional Career

Term	2021 to 2026 (Legal Education Board)

Legal Education Board (2021 to 2026)

In September 2021, President Rodrigo Duterte appointed Dumpa as a Regular Board Member of the Legal Education Board, representing the Law Students' Sector.

He was 25 years old at the time of his appointment.

During his five-year tenure, Dumpa served as one of the primary proponents of **LEB Memorandum Order No. 32, s. 2024**, which established the first-ever national policy framework for Law Student Welfare and Development in the Philippines.

He also contributed to the integration of the Shari'ah academic track into the national legal education system, a significant step toward recognizing the distinct legal traditions of Muslim Filipinos within the mainstream legal curriculum.

Bar Admission

Dumpa successfully passed the 2023 Philippine Bar Examinations, formally completing his credentials as a member of the Philippine bar.

University Service

In early 2026, he was appointed as legal consultant to the *Mindanao Varsitarian,* the official student publication of MSU Marawi, bringing his legal expertise back to the university that shaped him.

Cultural Significance

As a Maranao lawyer and former national board official, Dumpa carries a particular kind of weight in the Bangsamoro community.

His story, rising from a market vendor's stall to the boardroom of a national regulatory body, has resonated widely among students and youth in Mindanao, especially those from underserved communities who see in him a model of what meritocratic achievement can look like.

In Philippine legal circles, particularly on platforms like Abogado PH, he has been consistently portrayed as a symbol of earned success within a demanding and often inaccessible profession.

His advocacy for law student welfare also gives his cultural profile a practical dimension: he did not just succeed within the system, he worked to make that system more equitable for those who come after him.

Legacy and Recognition

Dumpa's legacy rests on several pillars.

He is the first Magna Cum Laude graduate in MSU College of Law history, a record that stands on its own regardless of everything else he has accomplished.

He helped author the first national policy on law student welfare, an achievement that has practical and lasting consequences for thousands of law students across the country.

His Best Thesis Award at PUP for a work on academic freedom reflects not just scholarly ability, but a consistent commitment to the intersection of education, governance, and rights.

And across all of it, he has been an unmistakably Maranao voice in national legal and educational policy, representing his community at a level and in spaces where that community has historically been underrepresented.

Challenges

Dumpa's path was built on overcoming material poverty and geographic disadvantage.

Growing up in Lanao del Sur, far from the major urban centers where legal education and professional networks are concentrated, he had to outperform his circumstances at every stage.

His background as a market vendor is not just a human interest detail; it reflects a structural reality about the barriers that face students from conflict-affected regions like the Bangsamoro, and why representation in institutions like the LEB matters.

References

- Legal Education Board. (2021). Appointment of Regular Board Members. Republic of the Philippines.
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See Also

- Legal Education Board of the Philippines
- Mindanao State University College of Law
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Philippine Bar Examinations
- Shari'ah law in the Philippines

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